

Voluntary Local Review (VLR)

What this tool produces · *A formally published review document that evaluates local progress toward the SDGs, highlighting successes, addressing critical gaps, and detailing future policy realignments.*

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

G3 · Proof of Anchoring

Dimensions

Regulation

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Voluntary Local Review (VLR)*

G4 · Proof of Sustainability

Why this tool matters

A voluntary act of radical transparency, where a city dares to hold a mirror to itself and publicly measure its complex local reality against its highest global ideals.

Evidence we produce

A formally published review document that evaluates local progress toward the SDGs, highlighting successes, addressing critical gaps, and detailing future policy realignments.

Duration & Material

Duration · 6 to 12 months for the review process

Material · European Handbook for SDG Voluntary Local Reviews, stakeholder mapping tools, municipal strategic plans

Reference case

Cities like Helsinki, Mannheim, and Ghent moved beyond standardized reporting by using VLRs to directly link their SDGs to local strategic plans and stakeholder consultations. This endogenous process transformed the VLR into a powerful mechanism for enhancing municipal accountability, cross-departmental awareness, and civic engagement, demonstrating that global goals must be rooted in local democratic processes,,.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

VLR cycle · align · measure · publish · advocate

Duration
6 to 12 months for the review process

Align local plan ↔ SDGs	Measure localized indicators	Engage citizens · academics · NGOs	Publish transparent review document	Advocate share lessons globally
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Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.